



NOVALITY STORE PRESENTS

Secret Santa & White Elephant Party Tracker

THE ILLUSTRATED USER GUIDE

12 linked tabs

2 editions

2 colour themes

Excel & Google Sheets

Novality Store — Secret Santa & White Elephant Party Tracker					
Novality Store Holiday Party • Secret Santa & White Elephant Command Centre Saturday, 19 December 2026 • Novality Loft, 12 Market Street • hosted by The Novality Team • 91 days to go! 12 guests • 12 in the draw • 10 white-elephant players • draw: Final — locked 19 Dec - bring a wrapped gift and a stealing face!					
PARTY AT A GLANCE					
PARTICIPANTS	SANTA ASSIGNED	GIFTS PURCHASED	TOTAL BUDGET	ACTUAL SPEND	AVG GIFT COST
12	12 of 12	10	\$420	\$319	\$31.88
EXCLUSION RULES	W-E PLAYERS	GIFTS IN PLAY	LOCKED GIFTS	RSVP YES	COMPLETION
4	10	7	1	10 / 12	47%
Gift readiness					83.3%
RSVP confirmed					83.3%

Plan the whole festive season in one file: guests, the draw, exclusions, budgets, wishlists, the white elephant game and printable cards – all wired together so the dashboard updates itself.



What's in the box

Six workbooks

File	What it is
PREMIUM Noel / Arctic	The full 12-tab tracker, blank and ready for your party
PREMIUM EXAMPLE	The same file filled with a demo party – peek at it first
BASIC Noel / Arctic	Guests, draw and budgets – the lean 7-tab edition
BASIC EXAMPLE	The demo party in BASIC form

PREMIUM or BASIC?

Feature	PREMIUM	BASIC
Guest list + RSVP	yes	yes
Automatic Secret Santa draw	yes	yes
Budget tracker	yes	yes
Exclusions & house rules	yes	-
Wishlists	yes	-
White Elephant game board	yes	-
Game history + live stats	yes	-
Printable Santa cards	yes	-

Where it works

- ✓ Excel 2016 or later, Microsoft 365 – everything is native Excel (formulas, dropdowns, conditional formatting, charts).
- ✓ Google Sheets – upload the .xlsx to Drive and open with Sheets; the formulas translate automatically.
- ✓ Apple Numbers – drag the file onto Numbers; charts may need a small nudge, everything else converts cleanly.

The maths is locked (on purpose)

Every formula cell is protected so a stray keystroke cannot break the tracker. Your typing cells – the cream ones – stay open. Need to unlock something? The Start Here tab inside the workbook explains how. The EXAMPLE files are just for looking: start your real party in a blank file.

Set up your party

- 1 **Open a blank PREMIUM file**
Start with Secret_Santa_White_Elephant_Tracker_PREMIUM_Noel.xlsx (or Arctic - same tracker, different colours).
- 2 **Go to the Settings tab**
Type your party name, date, host and location. The dashboard headline and the days-to-go counter follow instantly.
- 3 **Set the gift budget**
Budget min and max per person (for example 20 - 35). Every budget row and the dashboard total use these numbers.
- 4 **Pick a currency**
The currency symbol drives every money figure in the file.
- 5 **Choose a draw seed**
Any whole number. The seed shuffles the draw - same seed, same draw; new seed, brand new draw.
- 6 **Save the message**
The party message appears on the dashboard banner. Done - the tracker is ready for guests.

 Novality Store — Secret Santa & White Elephant Party Tracker

 Dashboard!A1

 THE PARTY

Party name	Novality Store Holiday Party
Dashboard message of the day	19 Dec - bring a wrapped gift and a stealing face!

 RULES OF THE GAME

Currency symbol	\$
Party year (used everywhere)	2,026
Party date	19 Dec 2026
Location	Novality Loft, 12 Market Street
Host	The Novality Team
Minimum gift budget	20.00
Maximum gift budget	35.00
Max steals per gift (White Elephant)	2
Starting player seat (White Elephant)	1
Secret Santa draw seed (change = re-draw)	6
White Elephant seat seed	7
Draw status	Final — locked 

 YOUR LISTS - rename or add, every dropdown follows

Studio	Vegetarian
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Add your guests

One row per guest on the Participants tab. Everything else in the workbook – the draw, the budget, the white elephant game – reads from this list, so add people here first.

Novality Store — Secret Santa & White Elephant Party Tracker									
 Participants Everyone in the draw - RSVP, household and team feed the exclusion rules automatically.  In the draw: 12  RSVP yes: 10  Awaiting: 2  Dashboard									
#	Participant	Team / dept	Household / couple	RSVP	Dietary needs	Gave to last year	Gift status	Wishes	Notes
1	Ava Novak	Studio	Novak home	Yes		Jack Byrne	Complete	2	Hosting helper - arrives early
2	Ben Carter	Shop		Yes	Vegetarian	Ava Novak	Gift Purchased	1	Owes Kia a bet from 2025
3	Chloe Diaz	Online		Yes	Vegan	Grace Liu	Wrapped	2	
4	Dan Novak	Studio	Novak home	Yes		Elena Petrov	Gift Purchased	1	Ava's husband - couple rule applies
5	Elena Petrov	Shop		Maybe	Gluten-free	Farid Khan	Not Started	1	Waiting on shift rota
6	Farid Khan	Shop		Yes	Halal	Chloe Diaz	Wrapped	1	
7	Grace Liu	Online	Flat 4B	Yes		Hugo Silva	Complete	2	Flat 4B - couple rule applies too
8	Hugo Silva	Online	Flat 4B	Yes		Grace Liu	Gift Purchased	1	
9	Isla Moore	Studio		No		Leo Fontaine	Not Started	1	Away in December - sad face
10	Jack Byrne	Shop		Yes	Nut allergy	Ava Novak	Gift Purchased	1	Espresso-machine feud with Leo
11	Kia Osei	Online		Yes		Ben Carter	Wrapped	1	
12	Leo Fontaine	Studio		Yes	Vegetarian	Isla Moore	Gift Purchased	2	
13									
14									
15									

The columns that matter

- ✓ Name - first name plus surname initial works best for the printable cards.
- ✓ RSVP - a dropdown: Yes / Maybe / No. The chips up top count them live.
- ✓ Household & team - only used by the exclusion rules (PREMIUM). Guests in the same household never draw each other when the couple rule is on.
- ✓ Diet notes & gift status - free text plus a status dropdown (Not started, Gift purchased, Wrapped, Complete) that feeds the readiness chart.

✓ Rows you don't need

Twelve rows are pre-formatted; blank rows simply stay blank everywhere - the draw skips them and the dashboard ignores them.

Run the Secret Santa draw

The draw tab assigns every guest exactly one recipient – no one draws themselves, and no pair repeats. The shuffle comes from your draw seed, so it is reproducible: change the seed on Settings and the whole draw reshuffles.

#	Giver	Drawn (auto)	Manual override	FINAL recipient	Rules check	Gift status
1	Ava Novak	Farid Khan		Farid Khan	✓ OK	Complete
2	Ben Carter	Grace Liu		Grace Liu	✓ OK	Gift Purchased
3	Chloe Diaz	Hugo Silva		Hugo Silva	✓ OK	Wrapped
4	Dan Novak	Isla Moore		Isla Moore	✓ OK	Gift Purchased
5	Elena Petrov	Jack Byrne		Jack Byrne	✓ OK	Not Started
6	Farid Khan	Kia Osei		Kia Osei	✓ OK	Wrapped
7	Grace Liu	Leo Fontaine		Leo Fontaine	✓ OK	Complete
8	Hugo Silva	Ava Novak		Ava Novak	✓ OK	Gift Purchased
9	Isla Moore	Ben Carter		Ben Carter	✓ OK	Not Started
10	Jack Byrne	Chloe Diaz		Chloe Diaz	✓ OK	Gift Purchased
11	Kia Osei	Dan Novak		Dan Novak	✓ OK	Wrapped
12	Leo Fontaine	Elena Petrov		Elena Petrov	✓ OK	Gift Purchased
13						
14						

Reading the tab

- ✓ Every filled guest row shows the drawn recipient plus a flag column – ✓ OK means the pair passes every rule you armed.
- ✓ A warning flag means the pair brushes a rule (for example the same household). Change the seed for a clean re-draw, or type a name into the override column to fix a single pair by hand.
- ✓ The status chip shows when the draw is final and locked.
- ✓ The print button in your spreadsheet prints just the draw area – handy for the organiser's eyes only.

Exclusions & house rules

The Exclusions & Rules tab is where you tell the draw what is allowed. Flip a toggle to On and the draw respects it instantly.

The screenshot shows the 'Novality Store - Secret Santa & White Elephant Party Tracker' interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with a home icon and 'Dashboard!A1'. Below this, a status bar shows 'Rules armed: 4', 'Draw violations: 0', and 'Custom pairs: 2'. The main content area is divided into two sections: 'HOUSE RULES' and 'CUSTOM NO-PAIR RULES'.

HOUSE RULES

Rule	Status
Couples / households cannot draw each other	On
Same team / department cannot draw each other	Off
No repeat of last year's pairing	On

(Self-draws are always impossible - the draw is a closed cycle.)

CUSTOM NO-PAIR RULES

#	This person...	...must never draw	Why
1	Jack Byrne	Leo Fontaine	Espresso-machine feud of 2025
2	Kia Osei	Ben Carter	Last year's regrettable candle
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			

The four levers

- Household rule**
On: nobody draws someone in the same household (the Household column on Participants).
- Team rule**
On: work teams never draw each other - set the Team column first.
- Last-year rule**
On: type last year's pairs into the draw's history column and they will not repeat. Keep it Off if this is your first year.
- Custom no-pair list**
Any other pair that must never happen - feuding cousins, identical twins, the hosts. Two columns, as many rows as you like.

The scoreboards up top

Rules armed counts your active rules and custom pairs; draw violations should read 0 after a fresh draw - if not, nudge the seed once more.

The budget tracker

One row per giver, mirroring the draw. The min and max columns come straight from Settings, so a budget change updates every row at once.

Novality Store — Secret Santa & White Elephant Party Tracker								
 Budget Tracker One row per giver: what they spent on their Secret Santa gift, checked against the party's min and max. Dashboard  Total spent: \$318.80  Average gift: \$31.88								
#	Gift for (recipient)	Min	Max	Actual spent	Budget check	Receipt?	Receipt / order ref	Notes
1	Farid Khan	20.00	35.00	32.50	✓ Within budget		NV-88121	
2	Grace Liu	20.00	35.00	24.00	✓ Within budget			
3	Hugo Silva	20.00	35.00	28.75	✓ Within budget		AMZ-4071	
4	Isla Moore	20.00	35.00	31.20	✓ Within budget			
5	Jack Byrne	20.00	35.00	18.00	● Under budget			
6	Kia Osei	20.00	35.00	26.40	✓ Within budget		ETS-2210	
7	Leo Fontaine	20.00	35.00	33.10	✓ Within budget			
8	Ava Novak	20.00	35.00	42.00	● Over budget		NV-88203	
9	Ben Carter	20.00	35.00					
10	Chloe Diaz	20.00	35.00	29.95	✓ Within budget		AMZ-4188	
11	Dan Novak	20.00	35.00	27.30	✓ Within budget			
12	Elena Petrov	20.00	35.00	25.60	✓ Within budget		ETS-2355	
13		20.00	35.00					
14		20.00	35.00					

How to use it

- ✓ Actual spent - type what a gift really cost; the status column colours itself: under budget, within, or over.
- ✓ Receipt - tick✓ when the receipt is filed; the chip up top counts them.
- ✓ Reference & notes - order numbers, links, where the gift is hiding.
- ✓ The dashboard totals (total budget, actual spend, average gift cost) recalculate the moment you type.

Over-budget alarm

The over-budget chip on the Budget tab counts rows above the max - glance at it before you buy, not after.

Wishlists that avoid doubles

Guests jot down a few wishes each; whoever draws them can claim an idea with a tick so nobody buys the same thing twice.

#	Participant	Wish	Priority	Link / shop	Claimed	Notes
1	Ava Novak	Chunky knit throw blanket	Must-love	https://example.com/throw	☐	Any colour but grey
2	Ava Novak	Ceramic mug tree	Nice to have		☐	
3	Ben Carter	Single-origin coffee beans 1kg	Must-love	https://example.com/beans	☐	No dark roasts
4	Chloe Diaz	Vegan candle trio	Nice to have		☐	
5	Chloe Diaz	Linen tea towel set	Just an idea		☐	
6	Dan Novak	Whisky tasting set	Must-love	https://example.com/whisky	☐	Peated, please
7	Elena Petrov	Gluten-free chocolate box	Must-love		☐	
8	Farid Khan	Desk plant (low light)	Nice to have		☐	
9	Grace Liu	Silk scrunchie set	Just an idea		☐	
10	Grace Liu	Matcha ceremony kit	Must-love	https://example.com/matcha	☐	
11	Hugo Silva	Vinyl: jazz classics	Nice to have		☐	
12	Jack Byrne	Espresso tamp mat	Must-love		☐	Obvious reasons
13	Kia Osei	Botanical print A4	Nice to have		☐	
14	Leo Fontaine	Sourdough starter kit	Just an idea		☐	

The trick is the claim column

- ✓ Guest, wish and a category (Must-love, Nice-to-have, Idea, Please-not) - a dropdown keeps it tidy.
- ✓ Claimed✓ marks an idea as taken; the chips count open must-loves so the important wishes never sit unclaimed.
- ✓ Price hint and link columns make remote shopping painless.
- ✓ Sort or filter the table by guest when you are doing the buying.

\$ Price hints keep budgets sane

Wishes carry an optional price hint - when a guest logs one, it lands right next to the budget range from Settings, so the buyer instantly sees which wishes fit the agreed budget and which need a group top-up.

The White Elephant board

Ten gift slots, one row each. Seats are numbered automatically in a random-but-stable order, and the board tracks who holds what as the game unfolds.

White Elephant

Seats and gift numbers shuffle from the seed; holders, steal counts and locks follow [Game History](#).

[Dashboard](#)

🎮 Players: 10

🎁 In play: 7

🔒 Locked: 1

🙌 Now: seat 5 (Chloe Diaz)

#	Seat	Player	Gift #	Gift description	Gift value	Steals	Max	Gift status	Current holder	Last stolen from	Final?
1	9	Ava Novak	9	Giant pickle plushie	12.00	1	2	🔪 Stolen	Ben Carter	Jack Byrne	
2	7	Ben Carter	5	Disco-ball bauble set	15.50	0	2	👉 Held	Dan Novak		
3	5	Chloe Diaz	2	Mystery sealed box	20.00	0	2	👉 Held	Kia Osei		
4	3	Dan Novak	8	Heated mug coaster	18.25	0	2	📦 Available			
5	2	Elena Petrov	4	Llama Christmas jumper	22.00	2	2	🔒 Final	Chloe Diaz		
6	1	Farid Khan	1	Singing fish plaque	14.75	1	2	🔪 Stolen	Ava Novak	Hugo Silva	
7	10	Grace Liu	7	Fancy hot chocolate tin	16.40	0	2	👉 Held	Elena Petrov		
8	8	Hugo Silva	3	Desktop zen garden	19.90	0	2	👉 Held	Farid Khan		
9	6	Jack Byrne	10	Reindeer antler headband	11.30	0	2	📦 Available			
10	4	Kia Osei	6	Marble cheese board	24.50	0	2	👉 Held	Grace Liu		
11											
12											
13											
14											

Statuses, decoded

- ✓ 📦 Available - still on the table. 👉 Held - someone owns it, for now. 🔪 Stolen - taken off someone; a stolen gift usually goes Final after the steal limit. 🔒 Final - locked, out of the game.
- ✓ The Now chip tells you exactly whose turn it is (seat number and name) based on the turns you have logged.
- ✓ The steals column counts thefts per gift - the dashboard chart turns it into instant drama.
- ✓ Max steals comes from Settings; when a gift hits the limit it locks itself Final.

📝 You never edit the board itself

Holder, thief and status columns are all formulas driven by the Game History tab on the next page - log the turns there and this board plays itself. Only the gift description and value columns are yours to type.

Game history & Santa cards

Log every turn on the Game History tab – seat number, player, Pick / Steal / Pass, which gift – and the board, the Now chip and the dashboard all follow along by themselves.

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Game History

Log every Pick, Steal and Pass in order - the White Elephant Dashboard leads this log live.

 Turns logged: 14
  Steals: 4

#	Turn	Player	Action	Gift #	Stolen from
1	1	Farid Khan	Pick	4	
2	2	Elena Petrov	Pick	7	
3	3	Dan Novak	Steal	4	Farid Khan
4	4	Kia Osei	Pick	2	
5	5	Chloe Diaz	Steal	4	Dan Novak
6	6	Jack Byrne	Pick	9	
7	7	Ben Carter	Steal	9	Jack Byrne
8	8	Hugo Silva	Pick	1	
9	9	Ava Novak	Steal	1	Hugo Silva

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🏠 Dashboard! A1

 SECRET SANTA CARD • 1

Ava Novak

you are secretly drawing...

Farid Khan

budget \$20-\$35 • bring it by 19 Dec

Novality Store Holiday Party • Novality Loft, 12 Market Street

 SECRET SANTA CARD • 2

Ben Carter

you are secretly drawing...

Grace Liu

budget \$20-\$35 • bring it by 19 Dec

Novality Store Holiday Party • Novality Loft, 12 Market Street

 SECRET SANTA CARD • 3

Chloe Diaz

you are secretly drawing...

Hugo Silva

 SECRET SANTA CARD • 4

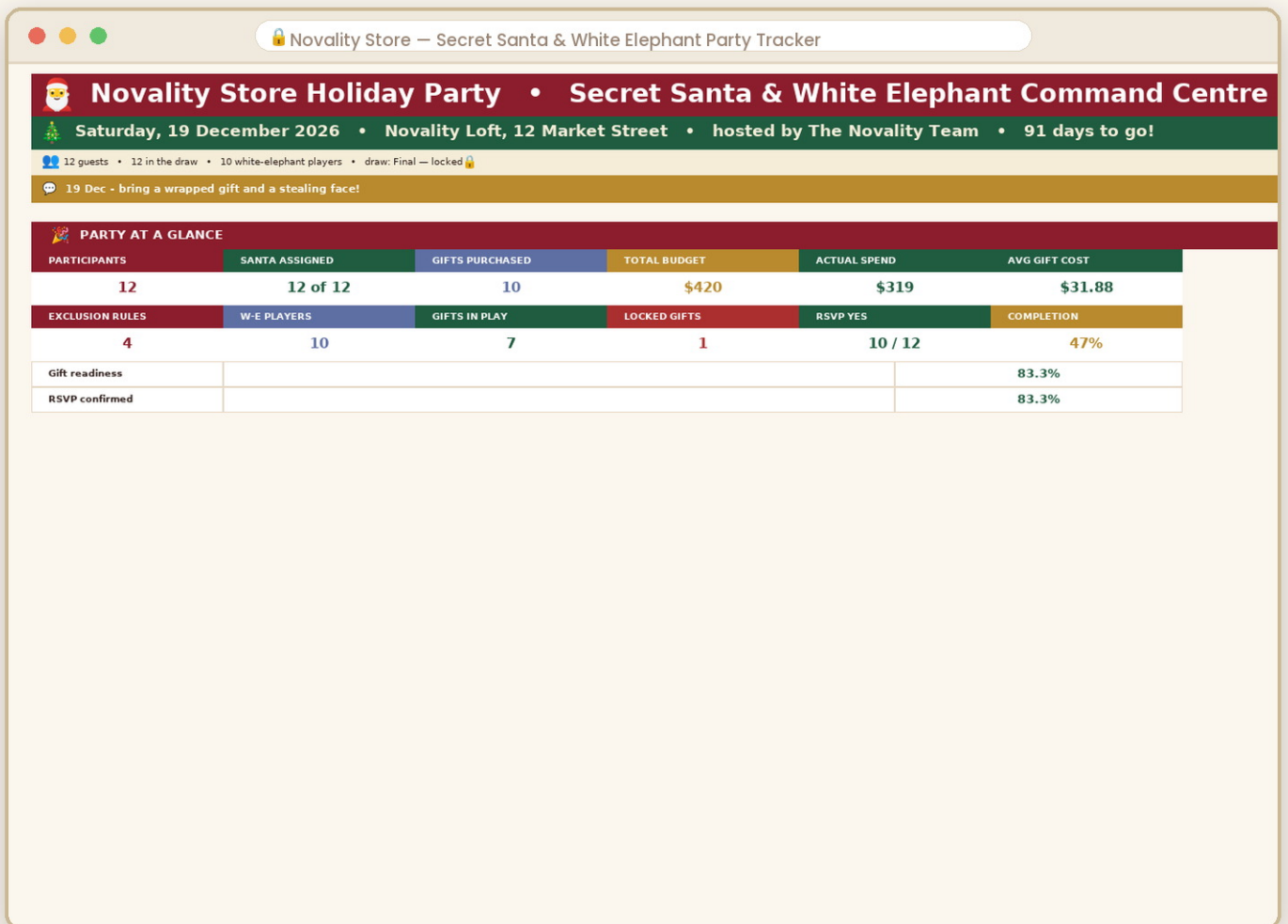
Dan Novak

you are secretly drawing...

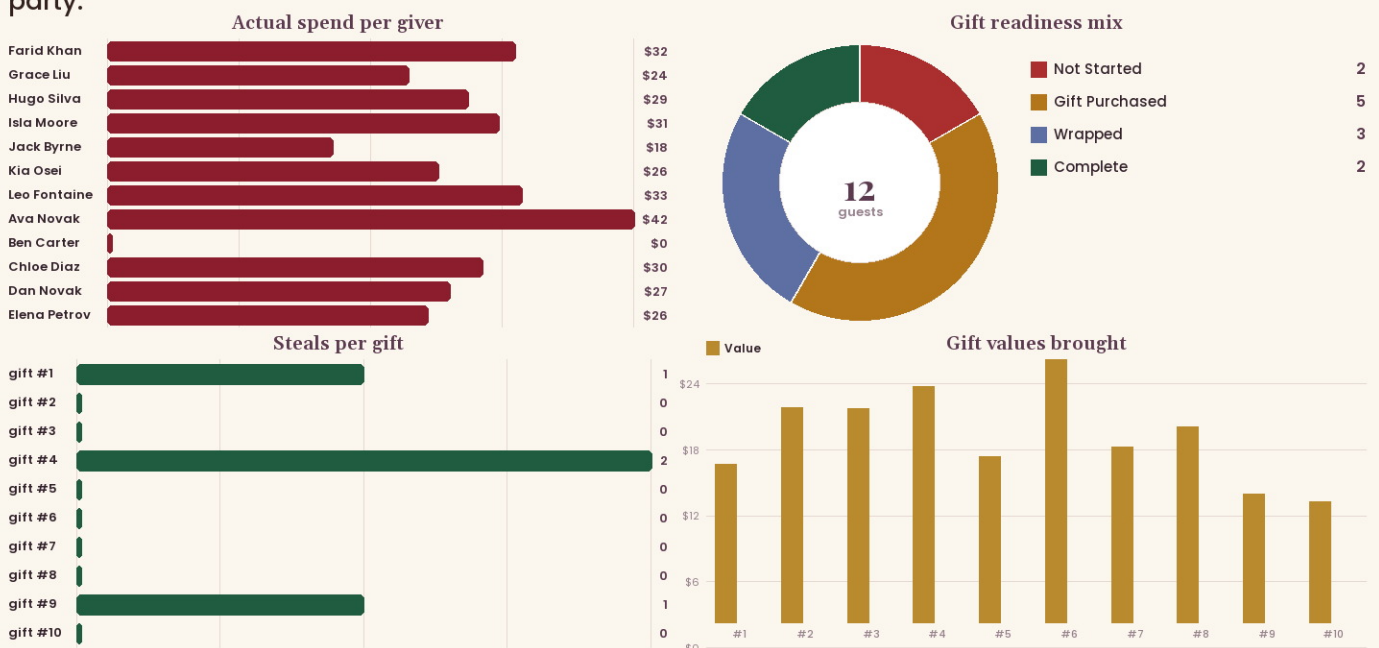
Isla Moore

The Santa Cards tab lays out fold-and-cut cards: giver on the outside, recipient inside – the secret survives the handout. Print, cut, fold, deal.

The command centre



Twelve KPI cards, four live charts, progress bars for purchases, wrapping and completion – every figure on this page is a formula, so it is always current. These are the same charts, redrawn from the demo party:



Ten tips for a smooth night

- 1 Add every guest before you draw – new rows after the draw need a seed nudge.
- 2 Draw early: the moment pairs exist, budgets and wishlists get useful.
- 3 Change the seed, not the names, when a pair brushes a rule.
- 4 Keep the couple rule On unless your crowd loves chaos.
- 5 Log white elephant turns as they happen – the Now chip keeps arguments to zero.
- 6 Photograph receipts the same night; the receipt column will thank you in January.
- 7 Print Santa cards on stiff paper; they fold in half by themselves.
- 8 Set Max steals to 2 or 3 – unlimited stealing is how friendships end.
- 9 Duplicate the file per year: last year's pairs then feed the last-year rule.
- 10 Open the dashboard on a tablet by the door; it doubles as the scoreboard.

Quick answers

Google Sheets?

Yes – upload to Drive and open with Sheets. The dropdowns, formulas and conditional formatting translate automatically.

More than 12 guests?

The pre-formatted rows cover a big party; blank rows are simply ignored, and you can insert more rows inside the table area.

Need to unlock a cell?

The Start Here tab inside the workbook explains unlocking – you will not need it for normal use.



Support

Questions, wishes or a stubborn formula? Message Novality Store through the shop you bought from and you will get a human answer.

Your purchase is a personal licence for your own parties – please do not resell or share the files.